

Product Design

Session 1 Feedback Report

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01 Performance Overview

You showed strong instincts early in this Product Design interview: three sharp clarifying questions and a genuine business case for the technology before touching features. Your prioritization was a real strength -- you used explicit criteria (user base size, goal alignment, consent risk) to narrow from four Google products down to Calendar, then to a specific use case, then to a specific pain point. But most of the interview's time went into that layered prioritization rather than user segmentation, multiple solutions, or metrics -- the interviewer had to redirect you with about seven minutes left. You landed on one solution and ran out of time before defining how you'd measure success.

What's Working

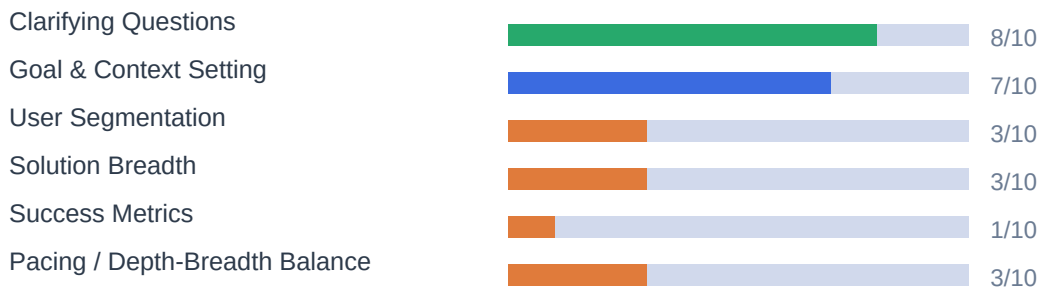
- Asked exactly the right number of clarifying questions (consent, integration scope, timeline) without over-clarifying
- Built a real business case (health trend, Google's data advantage, competitive moat, mission fit) before jumping to features
- Used named, explicit criteria at every prioritization step, not gut feel
- Took the interviewer's mid-interview pacing feedback well and adjusted immediately

Needs Improvement

- Never defined distinct user segments -- moved straight from "Google's users" to "which product"
- Only generated one solution idea; rubric expects 3+ distinct options
- Ran out of time before naming a single success or guardrail metric
- Spent too long re-prioritizing surfaces and calendar use-cases, crowding out solutions and metrics

03 Feedback Progress Tracker (Session 1 -- Baseline)

This is your first tracked session. Future sessions will show progress against these skills.



02 Deep Dive

The three lowest-scoring dimensions from this session

User Segmentation



WHAT YOU SAID

"So a few of the existing products that I'm thinking about is first Gmail, Google mail. Second is Google calendar. Third is Google meeting, and fourth is Google search."

HOW TO MAKE IT STRONGER

This is product-surface prioritization, not user segmentation. The rubric wants users split into distinct groups first (by role, work pattern, or relationship to stress) -- naming segments lets you justify feature choices by "who," not just "where."

Example: "I see at least three segments: (1) hybrid knowledge workers with 5+ meetings/day, (2) ICs with heavier async/email workloads, (3) people managers whose stress ties to 1:1s. I'd prioritize hybrid knowledge workers -- largest group, and their stress maps directly to calendar structure."

Solutions / Feature Ideas



WHAT YOU SAID

"So it can give us a dashboard ... a snapshot based on, like, okay, what meetings give us the most stress and then give a kind of recommendations of what to do based on those historical data."

HOW TO MAKE IT STRONGER

One idea, explored immediately in depth. The rubric wants 3+ distinct, non-incremental solutions generated before you pick one, so the interviewer can see your range and you avoid anchoring on the first idea.

Example: "Three directions: (1) a post-week stress digest tied to meetings, as described. (2) A proactive scheduling guardrail that warns you before booking onto an already high-stress day. (3) An auto-blocked recovery-time suggestion after a flagged high-stress meeting. I'd lead with the guardrail -- it's preventive, not just reflective."

Success Metrics



WHAT YOU SAID

"Them: Yeah. I think we run out of time, but, yeah, good job."

HOW TO MAKE IT STRONGER

Metrics were never reached. Build in a 60-90 second self-checkpoint once you've picked a solution, and state metrics before going deeper on any single idea, so this section never gets crowded out.

Example: "Primary metrics: % of flagged high-stress days where the user acts on a recommendation, and self-reported stress trending down over 4-6 weeks for active users. Guardrails: meeting acceptance rate shouldn't drop, and watch the feature's own opt-out rate as a signal we're being too intrusive."

04 Learning Plan

The single highest-leverage focus for your next session

YOUR #1 FOCUS

Pace yourself: cap prioritization time to protect solutions & metrics

WHY THIS MATTERS

Once you've picked a lane (e.g. Calendar -> meetings -> too-many-meetings), don't keep re-prioritizing -- move into generating solutions and naming metrics. Right now the layered prioritization is eating the time that solutions and metrics need, which is exactly why both came in thin or missing.

PRACTICE SUGGESTIONS

- Rehearse with a visible timer: ~3 min clarifying, 5 min goal/segments, 5 min pain points, 10 min solutions + prioritization, 5 min metrics.
- Force yourself to write 3 solutions before evaluating any one -- literally list three before you speak.
- End every mock rehearsal by naming metrics out loud, even rushed, to build the habit under time pressure.

Effort: Medium | Impact: High | +1.5-2 pts potential